

Judge Orders U.S. to Help Bring Deported Arizona Man Home

From: CBC World Mined: 2026-10-10 5 min read

A U.S. judge has ordered the Department of Homeland Security to help bring an Egyptian man back to the United States after he was sent to Equatorial Guinea earlier this year.

The man, Ahmed Soliman, lived in Arizona. According to court documents and published reports, he came to the United States as a young child with his family. He later lost his **permanent resident** status after a serious criminal case years ago. In 2024, officials began removal proceedings. Reuters reports he was deported in April before some of his court challenges were fully heard.

Soliman was sent to Equatorial Guinea under what are called **third-country deportation** arrangements. Those deals allow the U.S. government to send some people to countries that are not their home countries. Human Rights Watch has reported that hundreds of people were sent to African countries that were neither their citizenship nor long-term home between January 2025 and August 2026.

In a ruling seen by Reuters on Thursday, Judge John C. Hinderaker said the government must help free Soliman from **custody** abroad and arrange the travel papers needed for his return. The Department of Homeland Security did not immediately comment. Equatorial Guinea also did not respond to requests for comment, Reuters said.

Earlier, after a hotel incident involving migrants in Malabo was reported, Soliman was taken into police **custody** there. U.S. officials have said in court filings they received assurances deportees would be safe in Equatorial Guinea, and that they are not responsible for how people are treated outside the United States.

The case is about **due process** the idea that people should get fair hearings before major government actions. Courts can order agencies to fix problems when judges find rights were not followed.

Word Treasure

deportation -- When a government forces a person to leave the country.

due process -- The rule that people should get fair legal steps before major government actions.

custody -- Being held by police or officials and not free to leave.

permanent resident -- A person allowed to live long-term in a country without being a citizen.

third-country -- A nation that is neither the person's home country nor the country they left.

Background you need

Immigration courts and federal judges can review whether the government followed required legal steps in removal cases.

Some removal plans send people to countries that are not their citizenship or long-term home when governments have special arrangements.

Due process means people generally get a chance to present their case before life-changing government actions.

After a court order, agencies may be told to help arrange a person's safe return and travel documents.

Break it down

LEAD: Judge orders Homeland Security to help return deported Arizona man

KEY EVENT: Ahmed Soliman sent to Equatorial Guinea; court demands facilitation of return

+ - WHO: Soliman; Judge John C. Hinderaker; DHS

+ - WHEN: Deported in April; ruling seen Thursday by Reuters

CONTEXT: Third-country deportation arrangements; prior Arizona residency

EVIDENCE: Court order language; lack of immediate DHS comment

OPEN QUESTION: How and when return will be carried out

Why it matters

Court orders like this show how judges can check government power when people say their legal rights were skipped. Understanding due process helps kids see why fair hearings matter in public life.

Test what you remember

1. Who ordered help returning Ahmed Soliman?
 - (A) The United Nations secretary-general
 - (B) The president of Equatorial Guinea
 - (C) U.S. judge John C. Hinderaker
 - (D) A city mayor in Arizona
2. Where was Soliman sent?
 - (A) Mexico
 - (B) Equatorial Guinea
 - (C) Canada
 - (D) Egypt only
3. According to Reuters, when was he deported?
 - (A) In 2010
 - (B) In October
 - (C) Last week only
 - (D) In April
4. What must Homeland Security facilitate, per the order?
 - (A) His release from custody abroad and return travel papers
 - (B) Building a new prison
 - (C) A new U.S. passport for every migrant
 - (D) Closing all airports
5. Where did Soliman live in the U.S.?
 - (A) Alaska
 - (B) Hawaii
 - (C) Florida
 - (D) Arizona
6. What idea does the article say the case is about?
 - (A) Due process and fair hearings
 - (B) School lunch rules
 - (C) Space exploration
 - (D) Sports rankings

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: B 3: D 4: A 5: D 6: A

Questions to think about

1. Judge John C. Hinderaker: Ordered DHS to facilitate Soliman's release abroad and return to the U.S.
2. U.S. officials (court filings): Said they received safety assurances from Equatorial Guinea and are not responsible for treatment outside the U.S.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):